BOTANORA

N° 08



Crafting Blends

A method for creating your own blends

PDF GUIDE · 36 PAGES

BOTANORA · GUIDE N° 08

Crafting Blends

Create, test, pack and label your own teas

Making your own blend is the next step for anyone who already loves tea. It is composition: choose a base, add body, layer aroma and close with a finish, the way a perfumer works with notes. With a few ratio rules and a testing notebook, any kitchen becomes a small studio.

The guide covers structure, ratios, the flavour wheel, 38 formulas, six recipes using the blends, drying, roasting and scenting techniques, a batch calculator, a cost sheet, how to pack and label and what to check before selling.



01

Learn the structure

Base, body, aroma and finish.

02

Test small

20 g batches, written down.

03

Scale with the formula

Percentages work at any quantity.

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CHAPTER I

The architecture of a blend

Notes, ratios and ingredients

A good blend has one central idea and a few ingredients that serve it. The most common mistake is adding too much: eight ingredients turn into a generic "herbal tea" taste.

01 The four layers

02 The flavour wheel

03 Ingredients and preparation



CHAPTER I

The four layers

Think in percentages of total weight. The sum is always 100.

LAYER	ROLE	RATIO	EXAMPLES
Base	Identity and volume	50–80%	black, green, rooibos, chamomile, mate
Body	Texture and natural sweetness	10–25%	apple, coconut, cacao, toasted rice, roots
Aroma	What you notice first	5–15%	citrus peel, spices, mint
Finish	Detail, colour and beauty	1–5%	petals, lavender, vanilla

Practical rules

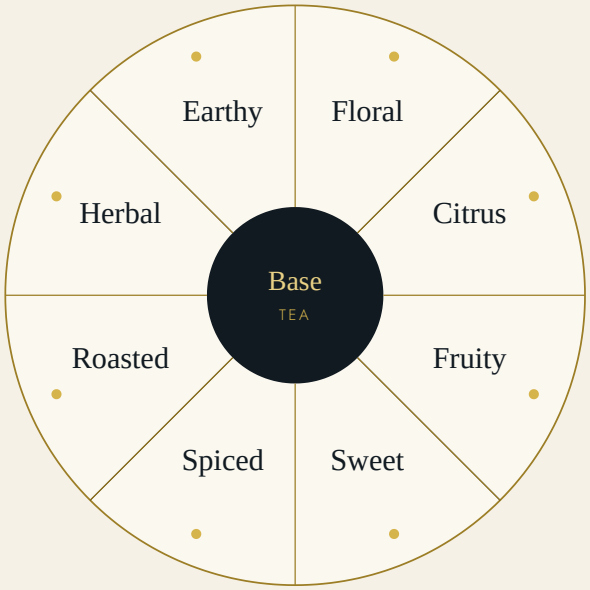
- **Three to five ingredients.** Beyond that, each one disappears.
- **Strong ingredients in small amounts.** Clove, lavender, liquorice and peppermint dominate above 5 to 10%.
- **Same steeping time.** Combine ingredients that extract at similar speeds, or cut the slower ones smaller.
- **Same temperature.** Green tea at 80 °C does not suit roots that need boiling. In that case, make two preparations.
- **Similar sizes.** Very different pieces separate in the pack and every cup comes out different.

A blend is a sentence: one subject, one verb and at most two adjectives.

CHAPTER I

The flavour wheel

Neighbouring families on the wheel pair easily. Opposites create contrast, which needs more care.



FAMILY	INGREDIENTS
Floral	lavender, rose, jasmine, chamomile
Citrus	orange peel, lemon, lemongrass
Fruity	apple, hibiscus, red berries
Sweet	vanilla, liquorice, coconut, cacao
Spiced	cinnamon, clove, cardamom, ginger
Roasted	hojicha, toasted mate, barley, rice
Herbal	mint, rosemary, basil, sage
Earthy	pu-erh, rooibos, turmeric, roots

BOTANORA TIP

To start, pick a base and one neighbouring family. Once confident, try a contrast: roasted with citrus, earthy with floral.

CHAPTER I

Ingredients and preparation

Everything in the blend must be dry, clean and low in moisture. A single damp ingredient spoils the whole jar.

INGREDIENT	HOW TO PREPARE	WATCH OUT
Citrus peel	No pith, thin strips, dried at 50 °C	Break into 3 to 5 mm pieces
Dried fruit	Small cubes, very dry	Avoid candied or sugared fruit: it sticks
Spices	Whole and crushed, never powdered	Powder clouds the cup and sinks
Flowers	Dried and food-grade	Florist flowers carry pesticides
Coconut, nuts, cacao	Lightly toasted	They contain fat: they keep less, up to 3 months
Oils and flavourings	Food-grade only, in drops	Apply to part of the blend and rest 48 h sealed

How to mix

1. Weigh each ingredient separately.
2. Mix in a large bowl with clean dry hands or a spoon, without crushing.
3. Start with the base and add from the largest to the smallest.
4. Rest 2 days in a closed jar before tasting: the aromas marry.

CHAPTER II

Twenty formulas

With and without caffeine

Formulas as percentages by weight. For a 100 g jar, 70% is 70 g. Start with 20 g batches to test and adjust to your taste.

01 Tea bases: black, green, white, oolong, pu-erh

02 Roasted bases: hojicha, genmaicha, mate

03 Caffeine-free: herbs, fruit, flowers and roots



N° 01

Golden Breakfast

Robust black with orange.

CAFFEINATED

70%	Assam black tea
20%	dried orange peel
10%	calendula petals

3 g, boiling water, 4 min. Takes milk.

N° 02

House Earl Grey

Bergamot with a floral touch.

CAFFEINATED

85%	Ceylon black tea
10%	dried orange peel
5%	cornflower or rose petals
drops	food-grade bergamot oil

Flavour the peel, never the tea directly. 3 g, 95 °C, 3 min.

N° 03

Seasonal Chai

Whole spices and black tea.

CAFFEINATED

60%	CTC or Assam black tea
15%	cinnamon chips
10%	dried ginger pieces
10%	crushed cardamom
5%	clove and black pepper

5 g simmered 5 min in water and milk.

N° 04

Garden Green

Sencha, mint and lemongrass.

CAFFEINATED

70%	sencha or Chinese green
20%	dried mint
10%	lemongrass

3 g, 80 °C, 2 min.

N° 05

Jasmine & Peach

A fragrant summer green.

CAFFEINATED

75%	jasmine green tea
20%	chopped dried peach
5%	calendula

3 g, 80 °C, 2 min 30 s. Great iced.

N° 06

Coconut Genmaicha

Toasted rice and coconut.

LOW CAFFEINE

70%	genmaicha
30%	toasted coconut chips

4 g, 85 °C, 2 min.

N° 07

Oolong & Fig

Honey, dark fruit and roast.

CAFFEINATED

80%	roasted oolong (Da Hong Pao, Dong Ding)
20%	chopped dried fig

4 g, 95 °C, 3 min or short steeps.

N° 08

White Floral

Delicate and perfumed.

LOW CAFFEINE

80%	Bai Mu Dan
15%	rose buds
5%	lavender

3 g, 85 °C, 4 min.

N° 09

Citrus Mate

For tereré or hot infusion.

CAFFEINATED

75%	yerba or toasted mate
15%	dried lime peel
10%	mint

Iced: 2 h in the fridge. Hot: 90 °C, 4 min.

N° 10

Caramel Hojicha

Roasted and sweet, almost dessert.

LOW CAFFEINE

80%	hojicha
15%	cacao nibs
5%	vanilla pieces

4 g, boiling, 1 min. Excellent with milk.

N° 11

Coconut & Vanilla

Sweet and creamy, caffeine-free.

CAFFEINE-FREE

70%	rooibos
20%	toasted coconut chips
5%	vanilla pieces
5%	cinnamon

4 g, boiling, 6 min.

N° 12

Rooibos Brazil

Rooibos, cacao and nuts.

CAFFEINE-FREE

70%	rooibos
15%	cacao nibs
10%	chopped toasted Brazil nut
5%	cinnamon

4 g, boiling, 6 min.

N° 13

Tropical Ruby

Hibiscus, passion fruit and mango.

CAFFEINE-FREE

40%	hibiscus
30%	dried mango
20%	dried apple
10%	rosehip

5 g, boiling, 8 min. Perfect iced.

N° 14

Sunday Digestif

For after a long lunch.

CAFFEINE-FREE

40%	fennel seed
30%	mint
20%	lemongrass
10%	dried ginger

3 g, 95 °C, 7 min.

N° 15

Red Winter

Spiced and fruity, caffeine-free.

CAFFEINE-FREE

40%	rooibos
25%	hibiscus
20%	apple and orange peel
15%	cinnamon, clove and anise

4 g, boiling, 7 min.

N° 16

Lemon & Lavender

Citrus and floral, for the afternoon.

CAFFEINE-FREE

40%	lemongrass
30%	lemon balm
25%	lemon peel
5%	lavender

3 g, 95 °C, 5 min, covered.

N° 17

Double Mint

Peppermint and spearmint.

CAFFEINE-FREE

50%	peppermint
40%	spearmint
10%	liquorice root

2 g, 95 °C, 5 min.

N° 18

Rose Garden

Petals and red berries.

CAFFEINE-FREE

35%	rose buds
35%	dried red berries
20%	hibiscus
10%	vanilla

4 g, boiling, 6 min.

N° 19

Green Focus

Green tea, rosemary and lemon.

CAFFEINATED

75%	green tea
15%	lemon peel
10%	dried rosemary

3 g, 80 °C, 2 min.

N° 20

Pu-erh & Cacao

Earthy, deep, a dessert tea.

CAFFEINATED

70%	shou pu-erh
20%	cacao nibs
10%	orange peel

4 g, quick rinse, boiling, 3 min.

CHAPTER III

From testing to packaging

Adjust, label and sell

A blend is ready after several versions. Write everything down, taste under the same conditions and only then think about packaging and selling.

01 Testing method

02 Testing sheet

03 Packing and labelling

04 Before selling



CHAPTER III

Testing method

Change one thing at a time. That way you know what improved.

1. **A 20 g batch** of each version, labelled with a letter (A, B, C).
2. **Brew the same way:** same water, temperature, time and cup. Use 3 g per 200 ml as standard.
3. **Taste at three points:** hot, warm and cold. Flaws show as it cools.
4. **Taste blind** when comparing two versions: ask someone else to pour.
5. **Test with and without milk and sugar**, if people are likely to sweeten it.
6. **Repeat after 2 weeks.** Some aromas fade; others come forward.

Quick diagnosis

SYMPTOM	ADJUSTMENT
Flat, dull	+ aroma (citrus or spice) by 5%
Thin, watery	+ body (fruit, coconut, root) or + base
One ingredient dominates	Halve it
Bitter or astringent	Less caffeinated base or shorter time
Cloyingly sweet	Less liquorice, vanilla or fruit; + citrus

CHAPTER III

Testing sheet

NAME AND VERSION

FORMULA (%)

BREW

WHAT TO CHANGE

AROMA ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

BODY ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

BALANCE ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

NAME AND VERSION

FORMULA (%)

BREW

WHAT TO CHANGE

AROMA ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

BODY ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

BALANCE ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

CHAPTER III

Packing and labelling

Packaging protects what you created. The label tells the customer how to brew it.

Packaging

From best to basic

A double-lid tin or a foil zip pouch: they protect from light, air and moisture. Clear glass only for home use, away from light.

USUAL SHELF LIFE	6 to 12 months
WITH NUTS OR COCONUT	up to 3 months

The ideal label

What it must include

Blend name, ingredients in descending order of weight, net weight, brewing instructions (amount, temperature, time), batch, production and best-before dates, and whether it contains caffeine.

Allergens and warnings

Tree nuts, peanuts, milk and gluten must be highlighted. Herbs with known restrictions (such as in pregnancy) deserve a clear warning, even when not mandatory.

> **BOTANORA TIP**
> An evocative name sells, but a three-word flavour description ("orange, honey, toasted") is what makes people choose.

CHAPTER III

Before selling

Gifting friends is one thing; selling is producing food, with its own rules.

In Brazil, teas and herbal mixtures are foods regulated by Anvisa, the national health agency. There is an official list of plant species authorised for teas, and plants outside it cannot be sold as food tea. There are also general and nutrition labelling rules and good manufacturing practices.

In other countries, check with the equivalent body (such as the FDA in the US or your local food safety authority) before selling.

1. **Check every ingredient** against the list of species authorised for tea.
2. **Register the business** with the appropriate food activity.
3. **Contact your local health authority** for a licence and guidance on the production space.
4. **Buy from invoiced suppliers** with certificates, and keep batch records.
5. **Do not promise therapeutic effects** on packaging or in marketing: foods cannot claim to cure or treat.

> IMPORTANT
> Regulations change. This chapter is general guidance and does not replace checking current Anvisa rules and your local health authority.

CHAPTER IV

Eighteen more formulas

Seasons, festivities and everyday

Formulas designed for the Brazilian calendar: Christmas, June festivals, summer and winter, plus classics like breakfast, Earl Grey and genmaicha with matcha.



N° 21

Spiced Christmas

Black tea, cinnamon, orange and almond.

CAFFEINATED

60%	Ceylon black tea
15%	orange peel
10%	cinnamon chips
10%	toasted flaked almond
5%	clove and star anise

3 g, boiling, 4 min.

N° 22

Spring Floral

Green tea with rose and calendula.

CAFFEINATED

75%	Chinese green tea
15%	rose buds
10%	calendula

3 g, 80 °C, 2 min 30 s.

N° 23

Mango & Lemongrass

Tropical white, great iced.

LOW CAFFEINE

60%	Bai Mu Dan
25%	dried mango
15%	lemongrass

4 g, 85 °C, 4 min or cold brew.

N° 24

Toasted Autumn

Hojicha, apple and cinnamon.

LOW CAFFEINE

65%	hojicha
25%	dried apple
10%	cinnamon

4 g, boiling, 1 min 30 s.

N° 25

Pine Nut & Mate

Southern Brazilian winter in a blend: toasted mate and pinhão.

CAFFEINATED

70%	toasted mate tea
20%	cooked, dried and toasted pinhão slivers
10%	tangerine peel

4 g, 90 °C, 5 min. Pinhão keeps briefly: up to 2 months.

N° 26

Alcohol-free Quentão

The Brazilian June-festival blend.

CAFFEINE-FREE

35%	dried ginger pieces
25%	orange peel
20%	dried apple
15%	cinnamon chips
5%	clove

Simmer 10 g per litre of grape juice and water (1:1).

N° 27

Cacao & Pink Pepper

Rooibos with nibs and a gentle heat.

CAFFEINE-FREE

70%	rooibos
20%	cacao nibs
7%	cinnamon
3%	pink peppercorns

4 g, boiling, 6 min. Good with milk.

N° 28

Green Apple & Mint

Tart, fresh and caffeine-free.

CAFFEINE-FREE

45%	dried green apple
35%	spearmint
20%	lime peel

4 g, 95 °C, 6 min or cold brew.

N° 29

Mint & Chocolate

Rooibos with mint and nibs: a caffeine-free dessert tea.

CAFFEINE-FREE

55%	rooibos
25%	peppermint
20%	cacao nibs

4 g, boiling, 6 min. Great with milk.

N° 30

Citrus Green

Three peels and a touch of ginger.

CAFFEINATED

70%	sencha
10%	lemon peel
10%	orange peel
10%	dried ginger

3 g, 75 °C, 1 min 30 s.

N° 31

Piña Colada Oolong

Light oolong with coconut and pineapple.

CAFFEINATED

65%	light oolong
20%	dried pineapple
15%	coconut chips

4 g, 90 °C, 3 min or cold brew.

N° 32

Earl Grey Provence

Bergamot and lavender.

CAFFEINATED

85%	Earl Grey
10%	rose buds
5%	lavender

3 g, 95 °C, 3 min.

N° 33

House Breakfast

A pure tea blend for milk.

CAFFEINATED

50%	Assam
30%	Ceylon
20%	Keemun

3 g, boiling, 4 min, with milk.

N° 34

Strawberry & Rose

Fruity, perfumed and caffeine-free.

CAFFEINE-FREE

40%	hibiscus
30%	dried strawberry
20%	apple
10%	rose petals

5 g, boiling, 8 min.

N° 35

Pear & Vanilla

A delicate dessert white.

LOW CAFFEINE

70%	Bai Mu Dan
25%	dried pear
5%	vanilla pieces

4 g, 85 °C, 4 min.

N° 36

Matcha-iri Genmaicha

The Japanese classic with matcha.

CAFFEINATED

95%	genmaicha
5%	matcha

4 g, 85 °C, 1 min 30 s.

N° 37

Pu-erh "Coffee"

For anyone giving up coffee.

CAFFEINATED

60%	shou pu-erh
25%	roasted barley
15%	cacao nibs

5 g, boiling, 4 min. With milk.

N° 38

Roasted Barley & Rice

Brazilian-style mugicha, caffeine-free.

CAFFEINE-FREE

60%	roasted barley
30%	toasted rice
10%	orange peel

10 g per litre, simmer 5 min. Great iced.

CHAPTER V

Recipes with your blends

From the jar to the table

Six recipes that turn your blends into lattes, quentão, syrups, natural soda and sweets to give as gifts.

01 Rooibos Brazil Latte

02 Alcohol-free Quentão

03 Blend Syrup

04 Sparkling Fruity Cold Brew

05 Tea Mug Cake

06 Christmas Tea Biscuits



01 Rooibos Brazil Latte

The cacao and nut blend turned café drink.

Hot · 8 min · 1 mug · 250 ml · Caffeine-free · With milk · Easy

INGREDIENTS

5 g	Rooibos Brazil blend
100 ml	boiling water
150 ml	milk
1 tsp	honey or panela syrup

Finish. Cocoa powder on top.

METHOD

1. Steep the blend in the water for 6 min, concentrated. Strain.
2. Sweeten the concentrate.
3. Add the hot frothed milk.

BARISTA TIP To sell as a "concentrate", double the blend and bottle it: it keeps 5 days in the fridge.

02 Alcohol-free Quentão

The June-festival blend with grape juice.

Hot · 20 min · 1 pot · 2 L · Caffeine-free · Easy

INGREDIENTS

20 g	Alcohol-free Quentão blend
1 L	pure grape juice
1 L	water
3 tbsp	brown sugar (optional)

Finish. An orange wheel.

METHOD

1. Simmer the water with the blend for 10 min.
2. Add the juice and sugar and heat without boiling.
3. Strain and serve hot in mugs.

BARISTA TIP Keep it in a thermos during the party.

03 Blend Syrup

Any blend becomes a syrup for drinks and desserts.

Hot · 20 min · 1 bottle · 300 ml · Caffeinated · Easy

INGREDIENTS

10 g	blend of your choice
250 ml	boiling water
200 g	sugar

METHOD

1. Steep the blend for 5 min (twice as strong as usual).
2. Strain, add the sugar and simmer 3 min.
3. Cool and bottle.

BARISTA TIP Keeps 3 weeks in the fridge. Earl Grey Provence and Strawberry & Rose make the best syrups.

04 Sparkling Fruity Cold Brew

The studio's natural soda.

Iced · 5 min + 8 h · 1 L · Caffeine-free · Easy

INGREDIENTS

15 g	Strawberry & Rose or Tropical Ruby
500 ml	cold water
500 ml	chilled sparkling water
2 tbsp	blend syrup

METHOD

1. Cold brew the blend in the cold water for 8 h.
2. Strain and sweeten with the syrup.
3. At serving time, top up with the sparkling water.

BARISTA TIP Double concentrate + fizz at the last moment = soda colour and taste, no dyes.

05 Tea Mug Cake

Three minutes in the microwave.

Hot · 5 min · 1 mug · Caffeinated · With milk · Easy

INGREDIENTS

4 tbsp	plain flour
3 tbsp	sugar
1 tsp	blend ground in a mortar (Earl Grey, Chai or Christmas)
1	egg
3 tbsp	milk
2 tbsp	oil
½ tsp	baking powder

Finish. A spoon of yoghurt on top.

METHOD

1. Mix the dry ingredients in the mug.
2. Add egg, milk and oil and stir with a fork until smooth.
3. Microwave on high for 1 min 30 s to 2 min.

BARISTA TIP Grind only the leaves and spices; remove hard fruit pieces first.

06 Christmas Tea Biscuits

To gift along with the blend.

Hot · 30 min + 30 min · ≈ 30 biscuits · Caffeinated · With milk · Intermediate

INGREDIENTS

200 g	plain flour
100 g	cold butter
80 g	brown sugar
1	egg
2 tbsp	finely ground Spiced Christmas blend
1 pinch	salt

Finish. Icing sugar with cinnamon.

METHOD

1. Rub the flour, blend, salt and butter together with your fingertips.
2. Add sugar and egg and form a dough. Chill for 30 min.
3. Roll to 4 mm, cut with cutters and bake at 170 °C for 12 to 14 min.

BARISTA TIP A tin of biscuits + a 50 g pack of the same blend is a ready-made gift kit.

CHAPTER VI

Studio techniques

Dry, roast, scent

Making some ingredients at home lowers costs and gives flavour you cannot buy ready-made.

01 Drying fruit and peel

02 Roasting grains and leaves

03 Scenting safely

04 38 blender ingredients



STUDIO TECHNIQUES

Drying fruit and peel

Oven at the lowest setting (60 to 70 °C), door ajar, tray lined with baking paper.

INGREDIENT	CUT	TIME	READY WHEN
Orange and lemon peel	5 mm strips, no pith	1–2 h	snaps cleanly
Apple and pear	3 mm slices, then cubes	3–4 h	dry and leathery
Pineapple and mango	8 mm cubes	5–7 h	no moisture when pressed
Strawberry	4 mm slices	3–4 h	crisp
Ginger	2 mm slices	2–3 h	brittle
Petals and flowers	whole	in the shade, 3–5 days	crisp, colour kept

The jar test

Before blending, keep the dried ingredient in a closed jar for 2 days. If condensation appears on the lid or it softens, return it to the oven. Moisture is what ruins a whole blend.

BOTANORA TIP

Dipping apple and pear in lemon water for 5 minutes before drying stops them from browning.

STUDIO TECHNIQUES

Roasting grains and leaves

Roasting brings caramel, bread and coffee notes, and reduces bitterness.

WHAT	HOW	TIME	DONE WHEN
Rice for genmaicha	Cooked rice dried in the oven, then a dry pan	10–15 min	golden, some pop
Barley	Dry pan, medium heat, stirring	15–20 min	coffee-brown, bread smell
Green tea as "home hojicha"	Dry pan, medium-low heat, constantly	3–5 min	hazelnut-brown, light smoke
Coconut and almonds	Oven at 160 °C	6–10 min	light golden
Spices	Dry pan	1–2 min	they scent the kitchen

NOTE

Cool everything completely before blending or packing. Warm ingredients release steam and create moisture in the jar.

BOTANORA TIP

Bancha and cheap green tea leaves make excellent home hojicha. It is a way to use green tea that has lost its freshness.

STUDIO TECHNIQUES

Scenting safely

From the natural method to essential oils, always food-grade.

Scenting with flowers

The jasmine method

Layers of tea and fresh flowers in a closed jar for 12 to 24 h; remove the flowers and repeat up to 3 times. This is how traditional jasmine tea is made.

Peel and pod

No oil at all

Fresh orange zest or a split vanilla pod in the blend jar for 1 week scents all the tea. Remove before packing.

Food-grade essential oil

Minimal dose

Drop the oil onto dried peel or fruit (not the tea), mix in a closed jar and rest 48 h. Start with 2 to 3 drops per 100 g of blend.

What to avoid

For safety and taste

Aromatherapy oils (not for ingestion), excessive artificial flavourings, dosing oil straight onto the leaves and storing flavoured with unflavoured teas in the same jar.

SAFETY

Concentrated essential oils can be toxic. Use only products labelled as food-grade and follow the manufacturer's dosage.

STUDIO TECHNIQUES

38 blender ingredients

Usage ranges as a percentage of blend weight. Start in the middle of the range.

INGREDIENT	LAYER	RANGE	TIP
Black tea	base	50–90%	Assam for body, Ceylon for brightness
Green tea	base	50–80%	Prefer Chinese: it holds up better in blends
White tea	base	50–80%	Delicate: light aromas
Oolong	base	60–85%	Rolled leaves expand: weigh carefully
Rooibos	base	50–80%	Caffeine-free; takes anything
Yerba mate	base	60–80%	Green or toasted
Chamomile	base/aroma	20–70%	Flowers crumble: mix gently
Hibiscus	base/colour	20–50%	Dominates colour and acidity
Dried apple	body	10–30%	Neutral sweetness
Mango, pineapple, pear	body	10–30%	Small, very dry cubes
Red berries	body	10–30%	Freeze-dried give more colour
Coconut chips	body	10–20%	Fat: short shelf life
Cacao nibs	body	10–20%	Roasted, unsweetened
Toasted rice	body	20–50%	Genmaicha base
Roasted barley	body	20–60%	Coffee taste, no caffeine
Nuts and almonds	body	5–15%	Allergen: declare it
Orange peel	aroma	5–20%	No pith
Lemon or lime peel	aroma	5–15%	Sharper than orange
Lemongrass	aroma	10–35%	Cut to 5 mm

STUDIO TECHNIQUES

INGREDIENT	LAYER	RANGE	TIP
Mint	aroma	10–50%	Peppermint dominates; spearmint is gentle
Dried ginger	aroma	5–35%	Heat builds with time
Cinnamon	aroma	5–15%	In chips, never powder
Cardamom	aroma	3–12%	Crush the pods
Clove	aroma	1–5%	Very strong
Star anise	aroma	1–5%	Break into points
Black and pink pepper	aroma	1–5%	An accent, not a lead
Fennel seed	aroma	5–30%	Aniseed sweetness
Rosemary	aroma	3–10%	Resinous; a little goes far
Lemon balm	aroma	10–40%	Volatile aroma: use recent harvests
Turmeric	aroma/colour	5–40%	Stains: warn on the label
Liquorice root	finish	2–10%	Intense sweetness; avoid with high blood pressure
Vanilla	finish	1–5%	Pod in pieces
Lavender	finish	1–5%	Above 5% tastes of soap
Rose petals	finish	2–15%	Food-grade
Calendula	finish	2–10%	Colour, little taste
Cornflower	finish	1–5%	Blue, purely visual
Jasmine flowers	finish	2–10%	Intense and floral
Matcha	finish	3–8%	Coats the leaves and adds colour

PRODUCTION AND GIFTS

Batch calculator

With the formula as percentages, any quantity is simple maths: total weight × % ÷ 100.

Example: Spiced Christmas

INGREDIENT	%	20 G	100 G	250 G	500 G	1 KG
black tea	60	12 g	60 g	150 g	300 g	600 g
orange peel	15	3 g	15 g	37.5 g	75 g	150 g
cinnamon	10	2 g	10 g	25 g	50 g	100 g
almond	10	2 g	10 g	25 g	50 g	100 g
clove and anise	5	1 g	5 g	12.5 g	25 g	50 g

Your formula

INGREDIENT	%	20 G	100 G	250 G	500 G	1 KG
Total	100	20 g	100 g	250 g	500 g	1 kg

PRODUCTION AND GIFTS

Cost and price

Before selling, know what each pack costs. Fill this in for a 50 g pack.

ITEM	AMOUNT
Ingredients (cost per gram × grams)	
Packaging (tin, pouch, bag)	
Label and tag	
Waste (10% of ingredients)	
Your time (minutes × rate per minute)	
Fees (platform, card, shipping)	
Total cost	
× markup (2 to 3)	
Selling price	

Example

Ingredients R$ 4.00 + tin R$ 6.00 + label R$ 1.00 + waste R$ 0.40 + time R$ 3.00 + fees R$ 2.00 = R$ 16.40 in cost. With a 2.5 markup, the price is around R$ 41.00. Compare with the market and adjust the packaging, which is often the biggest cost.

> **BOTANORA TIP**
> Foil pouches cost a fraction of tins. Offer the tin only on the first purchase and pouch refills after that.

PRODUCTION AND GIFTS

Gift kits

Blends make perfect gifts: light, long-lasting and personal.

Tasting Kit

3 blends × 20 g

One caffeinated, one caffeine-free and one fruity, with a card explaining how to brew each.

Christmas Kit

Blend + biscuits

Spiced Christmas 50 g, biscuits from recipe 6 and a gold ribbon. Make it in November.

Night Kit

Caffeine-free

Coconut & Vanilla, Rooibos Brazil, a mug and an infuser. Great for someone stressed.

Make-your-own Kit

Experience

A base, four little aroma jars and a testing sheet from this guide: the recipient builds their own blend.

Details that add value

- A card with brewing instructions and the story of the blend.
- A handwritten label or a stamp.
- A dried sprig of rosemary, lavender or cinnamon tied into the bow.
- A visible production date: it shows freshness.

PRODUCTION AND GIFTS

Blend specification sheet

One sheet per approved blend. It is what makes batch 10 taste like batch 1.

BLEND NAME

FINAL FORMULA (%)

SUPPLIERS AND BATCHES

RECOMMENDED BREWING

CAFFEINE AND ALLERGENS

SHELF LIFE AND PACKAGING

COST AND SELLING PRICE

NOTES



Thank you for brewing with us

The Botanora collection has ten guides, each devoted to one way of living with tea. Keep exploring:

01 Signature Infusions
02 The Tea Atlas
03 The Night Ritual
04 Focus & Energy
05 Iced & Cold Brew
06 Matcha at Home
07 Backyard Herbs
09 Tea & Table
10 Yerba Mate

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